

# Yiting Miao

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Current location: Los Angeles, CA

## Research interests

My research is driven by a curiosity about the **psychological mechanisms** underlying communication phenomena. Methodologically, I am drawn both to **designing experiments** that isolate causal processes and to **exploring new computational methods** for analyzing large-scale data.

## Education

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| <b>2024 – Present</b> | <b>Tsinghua University &amp; University of Southern California</b><br>Communication Data Science Dual-degree Program<br>Advisor: Professor Kai Kuang. |
| <b>2020 – 2024</b>    | <b>Sun Yat-sen University</b><br>B.A. in Communication, School of Journalism and Communication<br>Advisor: Professor Jinguang Zhang.                  |
| <b>2019 – 2020</b>    | <b>Sun Yat-sen University</b><br>Psychology, Department of Psychology.                                                                                |

## Publications & manuscripts

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| <b>Peer-reviewed</b> | Zhou, R., <b>Miao, Y.</b> , & Jin, J. (2022). Positive Data-Driven Donation Behavior: The Effects of Message Framing and Evidence Type on Online Donation Intention. <i>China Nonprofit Review</i> , 30(2), 35–51. (in Chinese)                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Conference</b>    | <b>Miao, Y.</b> , & Zhang, X. (2026). Why We Share Falsehoods: Testing a Coalitional Account of Misinformation Sharing (accepted, 76th Annual ICA Conference, Computational Methods Division).<br><br><b>Miao, Y.</b> (2026). Prioritizing Utility over Accuracy: A Threat-Management Explanation of Misinformation Sharing (accepted, 109th Annual AEJMC Conference, Communicating Science, Health, Environment, and Risk Division). |

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|                       | <b>Miao, Y.</b> (2026). Not Gullibility but Strategy: Misinformation Sharing as a Life History Trade-Off (accepted, 109th Annual AEJMC Conference, Communication Technology Division).                     |
| <b>Under review</b>   | <b>Miao, Y.,</b> Fu, Y., & Zhang, J. Perceiving the Effects of Violent Media Content Causes Both Third- and First-Person Perceptions: Further Evidence for a Threat-Management Explanation (under review). |
| <b>In preparation</b> | <b>Miao, Y.,</b> Li, J., & Zhang, J. Cross-Cultural, Cross-Lagged, and Experimental Evidence for a Threat-Management Explanation of Third-Person Effect in Relation to Media Violence.                     |
|                       | <b>Miao, Y.,</b> & Zhang, J. The Cognitive Process Through Which News of Altruism Moves Readers: A Competitive Altruism Perspective.                                                                       |
|                       | <b>Miao, Y.,</b> & Zhang, X. Why Do People Support Surveillance? An Explainable Machine Learning Analysis of Psychological Predictors Using World Values Survey Data.                                      |
|                       | Zhang, X., & <b>Miao, Y.</b> Reviewing the Reviewers: Policy Framing and Error Trade-Offs in LLM-Based Content Moderation.                                                                                 |
|                       | <b>Miao, Y.</b> Before Adversity Arrives: The Cultivation, Activation, and Communicative Practice of Anticipatory Resilience (master's thesis in progress).                                                |

## Honors and scholarships

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| <b>2026</b>        | Annenberg Student Success Award, University of Southern California          |
| <b>2026</b>        | Graduate Student Government Travel Award, University of Southern California |
| <b>2021 – 2023</b> | First-Class Scholarship (three consecutive years), Sun Yat-sen University   |
| <b>2021</b>        | National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China                        |

## Skills

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| <b>Research methods</b> | Experimental design and causal inference; survey and longitudinal (cross-lagged) designs; structural equation modeling and mediation analysis; (explainable) machine learning; LLM-assisted content analysis. |
| <b>Programming</b>      | R; Python; Mplus; LaTeX.                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Languages</b>        | Mandarin Chinese (native); English (IELTS Academic 7.5).                                                                                                                                                      |